



Opaque paints

Dense, nontransparent paints that obscure the colors they are painted over. When opaque paints are mixed together, the results are dull.

Palette

A mixing area for paint, usually with segmented wells to keep different colors separate.

Pan

A small block of solid, semi-moist paint, which comes in a plastic box that can be slotted into a paint box. Paints are also available in half-pans, so a wider selection of colors can be put into a paint box.

Perspective

The method of creating a sense of depth on a flat surface. Perspective can be

created in a painting by using warm, strong colors in the foreground, and cool, pale colors in the distance.

Portrait format

Paper in the shape of a rectangle that is taller than it is wide. Traditionally used for standing portraits.

Primary colors

The three colors that cannot be mixed together from other colors: red, yellow, and blue. Any two of these colors can be mixed together to make a secondary color.

Resist

A method of preserving highlights on white paper or a particular color by applying a material that repels paint. Materials that can be used as

resists include masking fluid, masking tape, and wax.

Rough paper

Paper with a highly textured surface that has been left to dry naturally, without pressing.

Rule of thirds

An aid to composition, which divides a picture into thirds horizontally and vertically to make a grid of nine squares. Points of interest are placed on the “third” lines and the focal point is positioned where two lines intersect.

Sable

Sable fur is used in the finest quality paint brushes. The long, dark brown hairs have a great capacity for holding paint and create a fine point.

Scraping back

Using a sharp blade to remove layers of dry paint in order to reveal the white paper below and create highlights.

Secondary colors

Colors made by mixing two primary colors together. The secondary colors are green (mixed from blue and yellow), orange (mixed from red and yellow), and purple (mixed from blue and red).

Sizing

Sealing a paper's fibers with glue to prevent paint from soaking into the paper. Blotting paper is un-sized and therefore very absorbent.

Softening

Blending the edges of a paint stroke with a brush loaded with

